Jackie Brown  Artist Statement and short biography.

As a city dweller, I would walk out, seeking nature, responding to a collective memory of a time when there was a more direct collaboration between human settlement and the immediate natural surroundings, I would walk out to gather leaves and bark that had fallen to the park or wood floor. Cutting, sticking, sewing and piling, these harvest were fashioned into objects that reflected a domestic narrative.

Piles of bark and leaves balance, layer upon layer, like the towers of linens ordered into the airing cupboard waiting to live out their history.

A tender leaf was cut and stitched into a coat, a symbol of nurture and protection. A leaf, a vegetative organ whose function is to turn sunlight into glucose is strongly evocative to humans. The very language of its parts is familiar, cuticle, vein, epidermis. There is a connection

I have a strong desire to see the stuff of the earth. In a city, this stuff struggles to show itself under the mass of architecture and street furniture, but it is , holding up the sprawling conurbation. On walks to doctor's appointments, hairdressers, shopping trips I would collect earth bringing it back to the studio to be carefully sieved. This fine delicate soil would be used to make drawings.

Now I reside in the countryside, I am enveloped by nature.

I am currently focused on the heavily managed field adjacent to my studio, cut and shaped by growing crops and the use of heavy machinery. A settlement in the middle ages, it is haunted by previous rituals of the land.

With deep and slow observation, I can feel the marks and traces of these actions, silently witnessing the passing of time and the human engagement with this land.

In these observations and interventions, I am slowly becoming a part of the landscape, realising that we do not 'go out' into nature, we are nature. Returning to the material source, I attune to the past and present of this ancient place whilst acknowledging its future.

www.southlondonwomenartists.co.uk/user/jackie+brown

Instagram

https://www.instagram.com/jackiebrown4595/?hl=en

**Selected exhibitions & publications include:**

The Tangled Landscape. Stables Gallery. Folkestone. October 2025

The Telling Ground. Stables Gallery Folkestone.August 2025

Coltsden Field. Quested Gallery, Folkestone.September 2024

Material Concerns.Crypt Gallery, London.August 2023

Green, Bell House, Dulwich. London.May 2022

Body-As-Nature, Body-As-Self. Wheatfen Nature Reserve. July 2021

Survival, Toma Gallery, Southend on Sea, Essex.October 2020

Nothing Less, Austrian Cultural Forum, London.October 2019 - February2020

Pillow Talk, Goldsmith University Press.September 2019

Finders Keepers loosers Weepers. Autumn issue, Art Verve. 2015

Sculpture in the South East, Public Sculpture of Britain series.Liverpool University Press

Public Engagement

Jackie Brown has worked on many education and public engagement projects, across a range of age groups and career stages. From 2016 until 2019 she was Director of Education for SLWA.

**Selected**

My Place. Funded by the Stephen Lawrence Foundation. With students from Eltham College focusing on different life chances in secondary education. 2018.

Walk the Talk, Funded by British Heart Foundation and Eastbourne Borough Council with clients at the Old Bank rehabilitation centre, Eastbourne